

Both hosted and packaged apps have shortcut icons in Chrome's New Tab page, making web apps easily accessible to Chrome users who install them.

Creating a hosted or packaged app for your web service doesn't come with just a placement of your app icon in Chrome's New Tab page. You also benefit by an improved security settings system that was designed with web apps in mind. While normal web sites need to seek your permission every time they perform increasingly common functions (such as showing notifications, using the clipboard or using your location to offer a more customised experience) installable web apps need to ask for these permissions only once—when you install them to Google Chrome. This makes for a better user experience.

And the best part? Because Chrome is updated regularly, it supports all the latest bells and whistles from the open web platform, including HTML5 APIs and WebGL. This means that you don't have to wait to use these technologies; you can integrate them in your web services and deploy them without compatibility scares to the 160 million people who are all using the same version of Chrome.

Getting started

Think the app way

What could your app do?

Your app could make it easier for the user to send text messages, or help students get updates on their results. Either way, the success of your app depends on how useful it is to the common user. Using open web technologies such as notifications, geolocation, and WebGL for stunning 3D graphics, you can make your app stand out in the crowd.

How should your app do it?

After you have your product vision well defined, you can think about the form factor of your app. You can either choose to package it as a downloadable file or run it off the web; either has its own advantages and limitations. We will look into each of this as we go along.

Before you actually start building your app, here are a couple of things you should keep in mind.

► Remember what your app does

If your app bombards the user with different features, he/she might find it complicated or annoying to use. So, work towards exclusivity, creativity and innovation. In fact, it is popularly believed that judgements are made